

THE AVENGERS IN THE 1970s

THE DECADE began under the creative direction of writer Roy Thomas and penciler Sal Buscema with the Avengers consisting of Captain America, Yellowjacket, the Wasp, the Vision, and Goliath. The first months saw the introduction of the Zodiac crime cartel and the return of the Sons of the Serpent. The villain Arkon debuted and Earth's Mightiest had to hire themselves out as demolition experts to pay back rent on the Mansion. Roy

began a nine-issue epic centered on the Kree-Skrull War in 1971 with artists Sal Buscema, Neal Adams, and John Buscema. He then teamed with artist Barry Windsor-Smith to produce a story that pitted the Avengers against Ares.

Steve Englehart replaced Roy in 1972 and introduced the team to Mantis. A war between the Avengers and Defenders followed as did the return of Kang. Steve was also responsible for the Vision's origin tale and marriage to the Scarlet Witch.

Jack Kirby returned to draw the covers when writer Gerry Conway took over the title and revived Wonder Man. Jim Shooter succeeded Gerry and introduced Jocasta and Henry Gyrich in 1978. Shooter also wrote the acclaimed Korvac Saga with Bill Mantlo and David Michelinie. With a plot by Mark Gruenwald and Steven Grant, Michelinie then took the Avengers on the Yesterday Quest and explained the origins of Quicksilver and Scarlet Witch.

The Avengers #83 (Dec. 1970) The Enchantress pretends to be the Valkyrie. (Cover by John Buscema and Tom Palmer)



The Avengers #89 (June 1971) After overthrowing the Supreme Intelligence and seizing control of the Kree home world, Ronan the Accuser attempts to destroy Captain Mar-vell. (Cover by Sal Buscema)



Giant-Size Avengers #4 (June 1975) In a double wedding, Mantis weds Swordsman and Vision marries Scarlet Witch. (Cover by Gil Kane, Mike Esposito and John Romita)

The Avengers #157 (March 1977) After being turned to stone by the Enchantress, the Black Knight attacks the Avengers. (Cover by Jack Kirby and Joe Sinnott)

1970



The Avengers #73 (Feb. 1970) The Black Panther battles the Sons of the Serpent. (Cover by Marie Severin and Frank Giacoia)

1971



The Avengers #88 (May 1971) Harlan Ellison and Roy Thomas' story crosses over with the Hulk. (Cover by Sal Buscema)

1972



The Avengers #96 (Feb. 1972) The Vision loses his cool during the Kree-Skrull War. (Cover by Neal Adams and Tom Palmer)

1973



The Avengers #109 (March 1973) Hawkeye quits the Avengers. (Cover by John Buscema and John Verhoeven)

1974



The Avengers #122 (July 1974) Mantis learns that her father is a member of the Zodiac. (Cover by Gil Kane and Bob Brown)

1975



The Avengers #136 (June 1975) The Beast takes on Iron Man. (Cover by John Romita and Mike Esposito)

1978



The Avengers #170 (April 1978) As Avengers vanish, Jocasta seeks Ultron. (Cover by George Perez and Terry Austin)

1979



The Avengers #185 (July 1979) Quicksilver and the Scarlet Witch search for their roots. (Cover by George Perez and Terry Austin)